

labels to guide consumers while buying appliances. The label indicates the level of the energy consumption of the device in two ways- absolute value stating, which is the average number of electrical units that would be used by the appliance or use the star rating system. The star ratings range from one to five. The more the number of stars, the more energy efficient the appliance is.

BEE labels indicate higher efficiency of functioning in appliances. It allows customers to buy quality products that function well at the same time saving electricity costs. For Example, A star 1 AC tends to cost INR 3500 more than a star 2 AC over a period of 5 years in electricity bills at current rates. On the other hand a 5 star AC tends to save INR 7800 as compared to the 2 star over a 5 year period. The Government has made it mandatory for all appliances to have ratings by BEE starting in 2010.

EU Energy label: EU established an energy consumption labeling scheme called the EU Energy label. This directive along with several other directives made it mandatory that most white goods, lighting equipment and



cars must have EU Energy label displayed prominently when offered for sale or rent. Energy efficiency classes from A to G are mentioned on the labels as ratings of appliances with A being the most energy efficient and G being the least. The labels also give other useful information to the customers as they chose between different products. The information is further required to be mentioned on catalogues and included on web sites. A+, A++ and A+++ grades were introduced later for rating different products.

In order to allow manufacturers to use a single label in multiple countries in the European Union, words were replaced by pictographic labels. Labeling is separated into different categories based on the appliances' details, including specific model and materials details, energy class (rating A to G), consumption, efficiency and finally the amount of noise emitted. The label applies to various appliances like washing machine, air conditioners, ovens, dish washers, refrigerators, light bulbs, televisions and cars.

EPEAT: The Electronic Product Environment Assessment Tool is a method for customers to evaluate the effect of a product on the environment. It assesses life cycle environmental impact and ranks products as bronze, silver or gold based on a set of environmental performance criterion.